Mutation of Local Floer Chain Complexes across Hamiltonian Bifurcations

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August 10th, 2026

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QSMS Summer Workshop, Jeju.

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Contents

Based on a joint work with Hong-Kwon Jo (SNU), arXiv:2607.22178.

Main result. We describe the explicit changes of the Floer chain complex for generic types of Hamiltonian bifurcations.

- **Motivation and Preliminaries.**
  Bifurcations, the Conley–Zehnder index, and Floer homology.
- **Methodology.**
  Model Hamiltonian, Morse–Bott type cascade counting.
- **Chain complex mutation.**
  Result for 6 types of bifurcations.
  (Generic 4 types, $\mathbb{Z}_2$-symmetric 2 types.)

Motivation and Preliminaries

Motivation. Bifurcations and Conley–Zehnder indices

A **bifurcation** is, heuristically, the birth or death of periodic orbits.

Several recent works [AFvK+23], [AB25], [JKvK26] relate bifurcations to symplectic invariants, for example Conley–Zehnder indices.

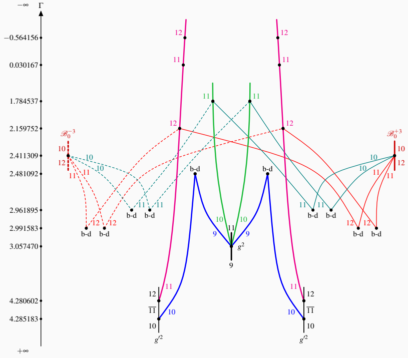


Figure 1: Bifurcation graph of Hill's lunar problem, [AB25].

Can we make a *symplectic dictionary* for bifurcation types?

Hamiltonian System and Periodic Orbits

Let (W, ω) be a symplectic manifold and $H : W \to \mathbb{R}$ be a function.

We define a **Hamiltonian vector field** by a relation $i_{X_H}\omega = -dH$.

Note. If $W = T^*\mathbb{R}^n$, $\omega = dp \wedge dq$ and $H = |p|^2/2 + V(q)$, X_H gives usual Hamiltonian equation in the classical mechanics,

$$\dot{q} = p, \quad \dot{p} = -V'(q).$$

Main interest is **periodic orbits**, which is an orbit γ such that $\dot{\gamma} = X_H$ and $\gamma(0) = \gamma(T)$ for some $T > 0$.

Periodic orbits form backbone of the dynamics, and also connects the topology and dynamics. (Arnold conjecture, Floer theory)

Poincaré Section

A **Poincaré section** is a transversal section $\Sigma \subset H^{-1}(c)$ at p.

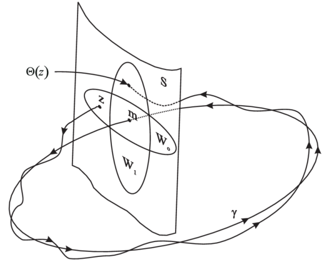


Figure 2: Poincaré section [OR99].

A **return map** is defined by $\Phi : U \subset \Sigma \to \Sigma$ by

$$\Phi(q) = Fl^{X_H}_{\tau(q)}(q), \quad \tau(q) = \min\left\{t \, : \, Fl^{X_H}_t(q) \in \Sigma\right\}.$$

Floquet multipliers are eigenvalues of $d_p\Phi$.

Stability

We call an orbit is **elliptic** if $\lambda \in S^1$ and **hyperbolic** if $\lambda \in \mathbb{R} \setminus \{0\}$.

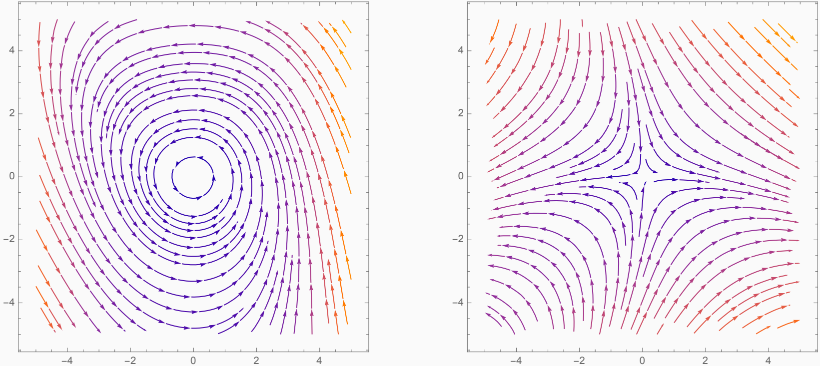


Figure 3: Elliptic and hyperbolic orbits in Poincaré section.

Bifurcation

Let $H_\varepsilon : W^4 \to \mathbb{R}$ be a 1-parameter family of Hamiltonians, and let γ_0 be a periodic orbit of H_0 with Floquet multiplier λ_0.

If $\lambda_0 \neq 1$, so the orbit is **non-degenerate**, then nearby periodic orbits form an *orbit cylinder*

$$\Gamma = \{(\gamma_\varepsilon, \varepsilon) : \gamma_\varepsilon \text{ is a periodic orbit of } H_\varepsilon\}.$$

This is a *continuation* of the orbit along the bifurcation parameter.

We follow γ_ε and detect λ_ε. If $\lambda_\varepsilon = 1$ at some ε, then γ_ε is degenerate, and the orbit cylinder may break:

- periodic orbits may be born or vanish; this is called a **bifurcation**,
- if $\lambda_\varepsilon \neq 1$ but $\lambda_\varepsilon^k = 1$, then the k-th cover bifurcates.

Example. Period Doubling

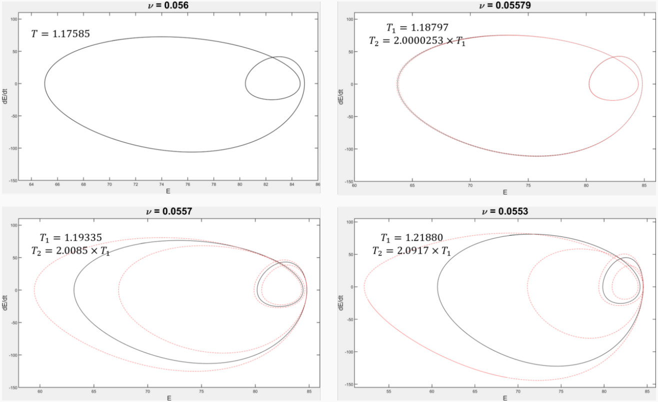


Figure 4: Period doubling in Kuramoto–Sivashinsky equation [Max21].

Period doubling is a generic bifurcation of a double cover.

The red dashed orbit is the new orbit that emerges from the bifurcation.

Conley–Zehnder Index

The **Conley–Zehnder index** $\mu_{\mathrm{CZ}}(\gamma)$ is an integer associated with a periodic orbit and can be understood as a *symplectic winding number*.

We are interested in a change of index along the parameter; $\mu_{\mathrm{CZ}}(\gamma_\varepsilon)$.

Along a non-degenerate family, the CZ index is constant.

Key idea. A change in μ_{CZ} = Degeneracy of γ_ε = A bifurcation occurs

Hence, a bifurcation can be detected via change of the CZ index.

Note. This is also useful in practical purposes. ([AB25], [JKvK26].)

Floer Homology

Floer homology $HF_*(W, H)$ is a topological invariant associated with a symplectic manifold W and Hamiltonian H. (cf. [AD14].)

This is determined by the **Floer chain complex** $CF_*(W, H)$, whose

- generators are 1-periodic orbits of H,
- grading is given by CZ indices,
- the differential is determined by counting **Floer cylinder**, whose boundaries are asymptotic to periodic orbits.

We will use **local Floer homology**, which is a Floer homology on a neighborhood of a periodic orbit, $HF_*^{\mathrm{loc}}(\gamma_0)$.

Across a bifurcation, CF_* changes substantially;

- orbits are born or vanish $\Rightarrow$ the number of generators changes.
- the CZ index changes $\Rightarrow$ grading changes

However, the homology doesn't change, so the differential is responsible for keeping the homology invariant. We call this **mutation** of LFCC.

Methodology

Outline

We're interested in the case such that $\lambda^k = 1$.

1. By **Birkhoff normal form**, find a generating Hamiltonian G_ε of Φ^k.
2. Construct **Model Hamiltonian** H_ε from G_ε.
3. Using **Floer cascade** to compute Floer differential.

Birkhoff Normal Form

We find the fixed points of the iterated return map Φ_ε^k.

This can also be done in the essentially same way by finding critical points of the generating Hamiltonian G_ε of Φ_ε^k.

1. If $\lambda = \exp(i\alpha)$, we can find a formal power series $G = \sum G_n$ of the generating Hamiltonian of Φ^k of the form
$$G_t = G_2 + \sum_{n \geq 3} G_{n,t}$$
where $\deg G_n = n$, $G_2^{ss} = \alpha(u^2 + v^2)$, $\dot{G}_{n,t} = \{G_2^{ss}, G_{n,t}\}$.
2. If $\lambda^k = 1$, $G_2^{ss} = 2\pi l(u^2 + v^2)$, which means that G is generated by polynomials commuting with rotation by $2\pi l$, i.e.,
$$G \in \mathbb{R}[\rho^2, \rho^k \cos(k\varphi - 2\pi l t), \rho^k \sin(k\varphi - 2\pi l t)].$$
3. Using rotating frame, we remove the time-dependency and G becomes an **autonomous $\mathbb{Z}_k$-symmetric polynomials**.

Birkhoff Normal Form

Ring of $\mathbb{Z}_k$-symmetric polynomials is $\mathbb{R}[\rho^2, \rho^k \cos k\varphi, \rho^k \sin k\varphi]$.

$\Rightarrow$ We can write the Hamiltonians by

$$G_\varepsilon = \begin{cases} \alpha u^2 + \beta v^3 + \varepsilon(au + bv + \dots) & k = 1, \\ \alpha u^2 + \beta v^4 + \varepsilon(av^2 + \dots) & k = 2, \\ \alpha \rho^4 + \beta \rho^k \cos k\varphi + \varepsilon(a\rho^2 + \dots) & k \geq 3. \end{cases}$$

Note. Only leading terms are relevant to observe critical points.

The critical points of G are fixed points of Φ^k, which is k-periodic points of Φ, so there is a k-**to-1 correspondence** except for the origin.

Model Hamiltonian

Let $\tilde{H}_\varepsilon$ be a Hamiltonian and G_ε be a generating Hamiltonian of Φ_ε^k.

We construct a model Hamiltonian on $I_r \times (\mathbb{R}/k\mathbb{Z})_\theta \times \Sigma_z$ by,

$$H_\varepsilon = kh(r) + G_\varepsilon(z).$$

where $h'(0) = 1$ and $h''(0) \neq 0$.

- k-to-1 correspondence between $\mathrm{Crit}(G_\varepsilon)$ and $\mathrm{Per}(H_\varepsilon)$, say $p \leftrightarrow \gamma_p$.
- $\mu_{CZ}(\gamma_p) = 1 - \mathrm{Ind}_{\mathrm{Morse}}(p)$.
- A gradient flow between p and q gives a Floer cylinder between γ_p and γ_q, which we call a **gradient revolution**.

Note. H_ε and $\tilde{H}_\varepsilon$ are different, but has the same return map, bifurcation type, and Floer-type data up to finite degree and symplectomorphism.

Floer Cascade

Our periodic orbits have an S^1-symmetry under time shifts, which makes the situation slightly different from the usual Floer theory.

We equip each orbit with a Morse function, and consider two critical points (max $\hat{\gamma}$ and min $\check{\gamma}$) as generators of a Floer chain complex.

In this case, the differential is given by counting **Floer cascades**; a sequence of Morse trajectories and Floer cylinders.

Floer Cascade

If there is a Floer cylinder $u(s,t)$ from γ_+ to γ_-, for $p \in \gamma_\mp$, we define

$$\mathrm{ev}^\pm(p) = \left\{ q \in \gamma_\pm \text{ : for } t_0 \text{ such that } p = \lim_{s \to \mp\infty} u(s,t),\, q = \lim_{s \to \pm\infty} u(s,t) \right\}.$$

Then we count

1. ($\mu(\gamma_+;\gamma_-) = 1$) Morse trajectory on γ_- from $\hat{\gamma}_+$ to $\mathrm{ev}^-(\hat{\gamma}_-)$, or one on γ_+ from $\mathrm{ev}^+(\check{\gamma}_+)$ to $\check{\gamma}_-$.
2. ($\mu(\gamma_+;\gamma_-) = 2$) Morse trajectory on γ_0 (such that $\mu(\gamma_0;\gamma_-) = 1$) from $\mathrm{ev}^+(\check{\gamma}_-)$ to $\mathrm{ev}^-(\hat{\gamma}_+)$.

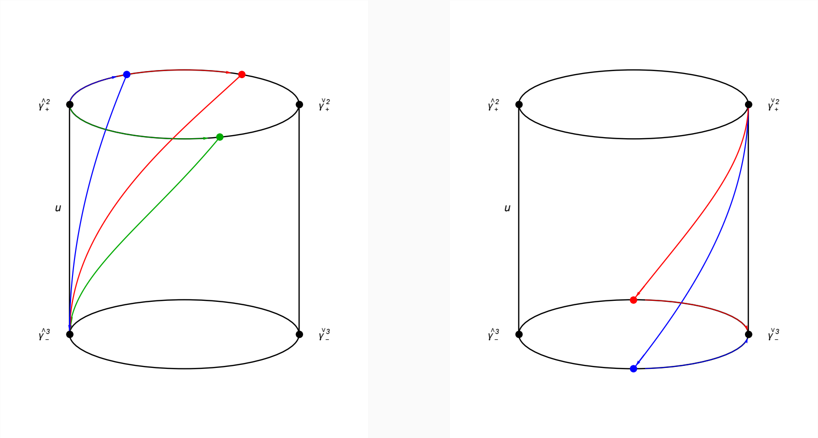


Figure 5: Cascades between 2nd and 3rd covers.

Cascade Counting Theorem

Theorem

Let $\gamma_\pm$ be two simple non-constant $1/k_\pm$-periodic orbits, so that $\gamma_\pm^{k_\pm}$ are 1-periodic orbits. Moreover, assume that

$$\mu_{CZ}(\gamma_+^{k_+}) - \mu_{CZ}(\gamma_-^{k_-}) = 1.$$

Then, the quotient $\mathcal{M}_0(\gamma_-^{k_-}, \gamma_+^{k_+})/S^1$ is a 0-dimensional $\mathbb{Z}_{(k_+,k_-)}$-orbifold, and we have

$$\#_2\mathcal{M}(\hat{\gamma}_-^{k_-}, \hat{\gamma}_+^{k_+}) \equiv k_- \cdot \#(\mathcal{M}_0(\gamma_-^{k_-}, \gamma_+^{k_+})/S^1) \pmod 2,$$
$$\#_2\mathcal{M}(\check{\gamma}_-^{k_-}, \check{\gamma}_+^{k_+}) \equiv k_+ \cdot \#(\mathcal{M}_0(\gamma_-^{k_-}, \gamma_+^{k_+})/S^1) \pmod 2.$$

In particular, if there is only one cylinder from a simple γ_0 to a multiple cover γ_1^k,

$$\partial\hat{\gamma}_0 = k\hat{\gamma}_1^k, \quad \partial\check{\gamma}_0 = \check{\gamma}_1^k.$$

Chain Complex Mutation

Meyer's Classification

Generic Hamiltonian bifurcations are classified in [Mey70].

They are organized by the covering number k of the underlying orbit.

- $k = 1$: birth-death
- $k = 2$: period doubling, materialization (opposite stability types)
- $k = 3, 4$: phantom kiss
- $k \geq 4$: emission

Aside. We will use names from [AM78], where three extra types involving critical points are given.

Other names: touch-and-go, period tripling/quadrupling, etc.

Note. The fourth cover is a borderline case, depending on the coefficients of the normal form.

Birth-death $(k = 1)$

A generic single cover bifurcation, with generating Hamiltonian

$$G_\varepsilon(u, v) = \alpha v^2 + \beta u^3 + \ldots + \varepsilon(u + \ldots).$$

- $(\varepsilon < 0)$ There are no periodic orbits.
- $(\varepsilon > 0)$ One elliptic γ_0 and one hyperbolic orbit γ_1 are born.
- There is one gradient trajectory between them.

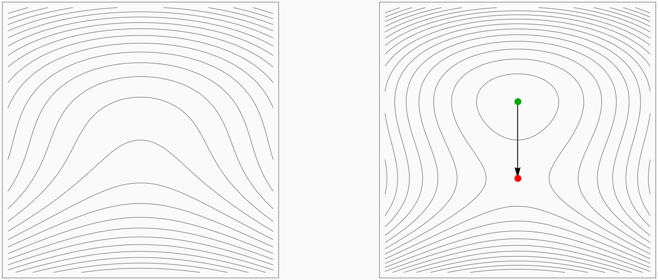


Figure 6: Critical points and gradient trajectories of birth-death bifurcation

In every picture, • is minimum, • is saddle, • is maximum.

Birth-death $(k = 1)$

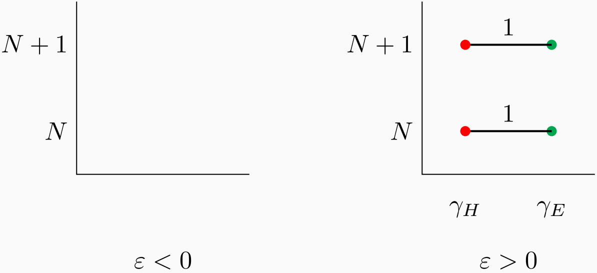


Figure 7: Chain complex mutation across the birth-death.

- Points at (n, m) corresponds to a generator of degree $n + m$.
- The line indicates the differential; $\partial(\hat{\gamma}_E) = \hat{\gamma}_H$ here.
- We are using $\mathbb{Z}_2$-coefficients.

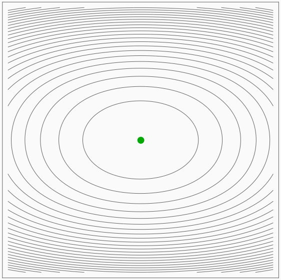
We have $HF_*^{\mathrm{loc}}(\gamma) = 0$, where γ is the degenerate orbit at $\varepsilon = 0$.

Period doubling $(k = 2)$

A generic double cover bifurcation, with generating Hamiltonian

$$G_\varepsilon(u, v) = \alpha v^2 + \beta u^4 + \ldots + \varepsilon(u^2 + \ldots).$$

- $(\varepsilon < 0)$ One elliptic orbit γ_0^2 exists.
- $(\varepsilon > 0)$ γ_0^2 becomes hyperbolic, and an elliptic orbit ($\bullet$) γ_{new} is born.
- There is one cylinder between γ_0^2 and γ_{new}.



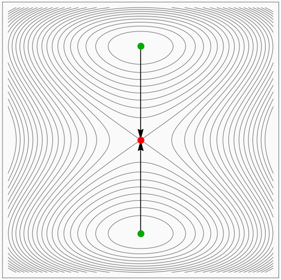


Figure 8: Period doubling bifurcation

Period doubling $(k = 2)$

- $\mu_{CZ}(\gamma_+^2; \gamma_-^2) = -1$ or 1. We assume -1 below.
- $\mu_{CZ}(\gamma_{new}; \gamma_-^2) = 0$.

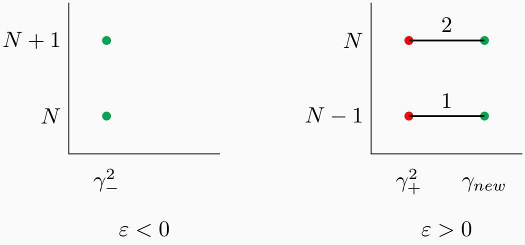


Figure 9: Chain complex mutation across the period doubling.

$\check{\gamma}_H$ and $\check{\gamma}^2$ cancel each other, while $\hat{\gamma}_H$ and $\hat{\gamma}^2$ do not.

$$HF_*^{\mathrm{loc}}(\gamma_0^2) \cong \begin{cases} \mathbb{Z}_2 & \text{if } * = 0, 1 \text{ relative to } \gamma_-^2, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Phantom kiss $(k = 3, 4)$

A generic 3rd or 4th cover bifurcation, with generating Hamiltonian

$$G_\varepsilon(\rho, \varphi) = \alpha \rho^k \cos k\varphi + \ldots + \varepsilon(\rho^2 + \ldots).$$

- $(\varepsilon < 0)$ One elliptic orbit γ^k and one hyperbolic orbit γ_H.
- $(\varepsilon = 0)$ They meet, and suddenly become unstable.
- $(\varepsilon > 0)$ The same configuration, but the index of γ^k changes.
- One cylinder exists between γ^k and γ_H.

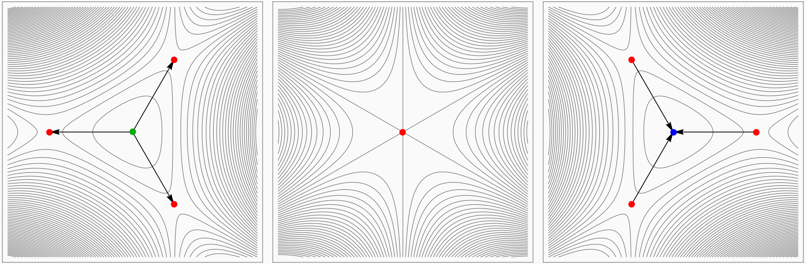


Figure 10: Phantom kiss bifurcation

Phantom kiss $(k = 3, 4)$

1. $\mu_{CZ}(\gamma_+^k; \gamma_-^k) = \pm 2$. Here, we assume -2.
2. $\mu_{CZ}(\gamma_{H,\pm}; \gamma_-^k) = \pm 1$, say -1, and it doesn't change.

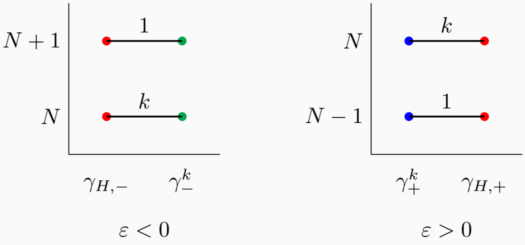


Figure 11: Chain complex mutations across the phantom kiss

$$HF_*^{\mathrm{loc}}(\gamma_0^3) = 0, \quad HF_*^{\mathrm{loc}}(\gamma_0^4) \cong \begin{cases} \mathbb{Z}_2 & \text{if } * = -1, 0 \text{ relative to } \gamma_-^4, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Emission $(k \geq 4)$

Generic $k \geq 4$-th cover bifurcation, with generating Hamiltonian

$$G_\varepsilon(\rho, \varphi) = \alpha\rho^4 + \beta\rho^k \cos k\varphi + \ldots + \varepsilon(\rho^2 + \ldots).$$

- $(\varepsilon < 0)$ One elliptic orbit γ_-^k exists.
- $(\varepsilon > 0)$ γ_-^k is still elliptic, and a new elliptic orbit γ_E and a new hyperbolic orbit γ_H are born.
- Two cylinders from γ_E to γ_H, and one cylinder from γ_H to γ_+^k.

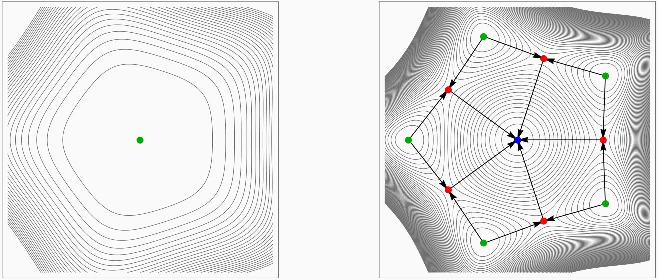


Figure 12: Emission bifurcation

Emission $(k \geq 4)$

1. $\mu_{CZ}(\gamma_+^k; \gamma_-^k) = \pm 2$, say -2.
2. $\mu_{CZ}(\gamma_H; \gamma_-^k) = -1$, $\mu_{CZ}(\gamma_E; \gamma_-^k) = 0$.

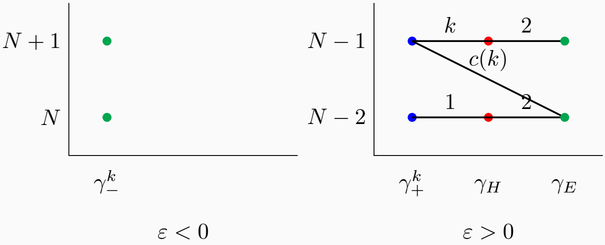


Figure 13: Chain complex mutations across the emission

$c(k)$ depends on the choice of Morse function, but always odd if k is even.

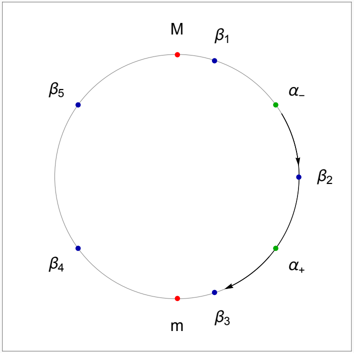
$$HF_*^{\mathrm{loc}}(\gamma_0^k) \cong \begin{cases} \mathbb{Z}_2 & \text{if } * = 0, 1 \text{ relative to } \gamma_-^k, \\ 0 & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Emission $(k \geq 4)$

To find $c(k)$, we need to count the cascade of length 2 from $\check{\gamma}^k$ to $\hat{\gamma}_E$, which is equivalent to a count of Morse trajectories

$$\mathrm{ev}^-(\check{\gamma}_E) \to \mathrm{ev}^+(\hat{\gamma}^k) \text{ on } \gamma_H.$$

This depends on the choice of the Morse function on γ_H.



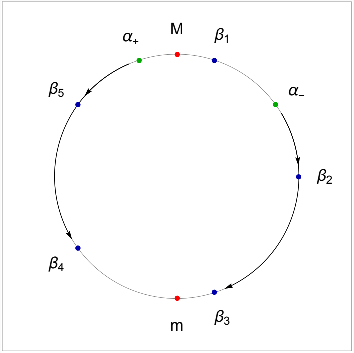


Figure 14: Some cases of $c(k)$.

Pitchfork ($\mathbb{Z}_2$-symmetric, $k = 1$)

For $\mathbb{Z}_2$-symmetric systems, we impose an extra $\mathbb{Z}_2$-symmetry on G_ε.

$\Rightarrow$ We analyze $\mathbb{Z}_{\mathrm{lcm}(2,k)}$-symmetric polynomials, so only odd-cover bifurcation produces new phenomena.

For $k = 1$, we have period doubling picture, where now two new critical points correspond to **two** new periodic orbits.

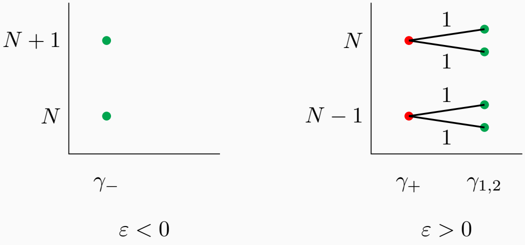


Figure 15: Chain complex mutations across the pitchfork

Double emission ($\mathbb{Z}_2$-symmetric, $k \geq 3$ odd)

For $k \geq 3$, we have $2k$-emission.

- There are two new hyperbolic and two new elliptic orbits.
- Cylinder configuration is changed. (One cylinder from each $\gamma_{E,i}$ to $\gamma_{H,j}$, and one cylinder from each $\gamma_{H,j}$ to γ^k.)

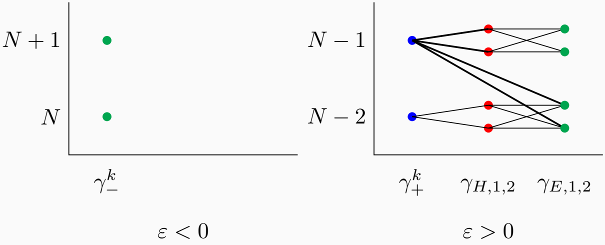


Figure 16: Chain complex mutations across the double emission

Further discussions

- Orientation and $\mathbb{Z}$-coefficients.
- More symmetries, multi-parameter, higher dimensional bifurcations.
- This gives a *generic* change of local Floer chain complex.
  $\Rightarrow$ Persistent module description and Floer-type Cerf theory?
- Bifurcation of symmetric orbits can be described as a Lagrangian Floer theory $\Rightarrow$ Similar work for Lagrangians?

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Figure 17: Thank you for your attention!

Questions, comments, and further discussion are welcome!